

PE-EC801A

Antennas and Propagation

Combined Module Notes

Modules 1 – 7

Semester VIII • 3L:0T:0P • 3 Credits

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Disclaimer / Study Guide Notice:

These are condensed **Short Notes** focusing on core theory, key formulas, block/circuit diagrams, and standard viva Q&As for university exam revision. Exhaustive numerical practice problems and derivation edge cases are not covered. This serves as a quick-revision reference guide for students.

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Module 1

Physical Concept of Radiation

1. Physical Concept of Radiation

Definition of an Antenna

An **antenna** is a metallic device (transducer) that transitions guided electromagnetic waves on a transmission line into free-space electromagnetic waves in the transmitting mode, or vice versa in the receiving mode. It serves as an impedance-matching interface between transmission lines and free space.

1.1 Mechanism of Radiation

Radiation occurs when electromagnetic energy is detached from a source and propagates into free space. The basic conditions for radiation are:

- **Stationary Charge:** A stationary charge produces a static electric field, but does not radiate.
- **Uniformly Moving Charge:** A charge moving at a constant speed along a straight transmission line does not radiate (unless the boundary conditions change, e.g., the wire terminates or bends).
- **Accelerated / Decelerated Charge:** Radiation is created by a time-varying current or by an accelerated or decelerated charge.

The acceleration of charge a_z is related to time-varying current by:

$$\frac{dI_z}{dt} = q \frac{dv_z}{dt} = qa_z$$

where q is the charge and v_z is the velocity. If a current changes over time, charges accelerate, which creates radiation.

1.2 Radiation from Single Wire, Two Wires, and Open-End Transmission Line

- **Single Wire:** If a charge is accelerated along a curved wire, it radiates.
- **Two Wires (Transmission Line):** In a two-wire parallel transmission line, the spacing between the conductors is much smaller than the wavelength ($d \ll \lambda$). The currents flow in opposite directions, so the radiated fields from the two wires cancel out in the far field. Consequently, the line acts purely as a guide.

- **Bended/Flared Line:** If the two wires are flared outward (bent), the currents are no longer anti-parallel. Their fields do not cancel, and energy is released as radiated waves.

2. Radiation Pattern and Field Regions

Definition of Radiation Pattern

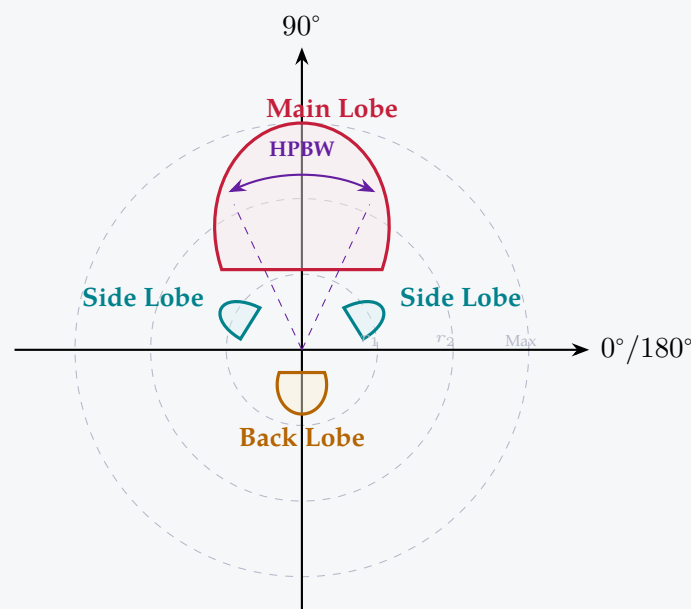
A **radiation pattern** (or antenna pattern) is a mathematical function or graphical representation of the radiation properties of the antenna as a function of space coordinates (typically spherical coordinates θ, ϕ). These properties include power flux density, field intensity, phase, and polarization.

2.1 Lobe Structure of Radiation Pattern

An antenna radiation pattern typically consists of various lobes:

- **Major Lobe (Main Lobe):** The radiation lobe containing the direction of maximum radiation.
- **Minor Lobe:** Any lobe other than the major lobe. These represent unwanted radiation.
- **Side Lobe:** A minor lobe in any direction other than the intended lobe.
- **Back Lobe:** A minor lobe whose axis is approximately 180° from the main beam.

Antenna Radiation Pattern — Lobe Structure

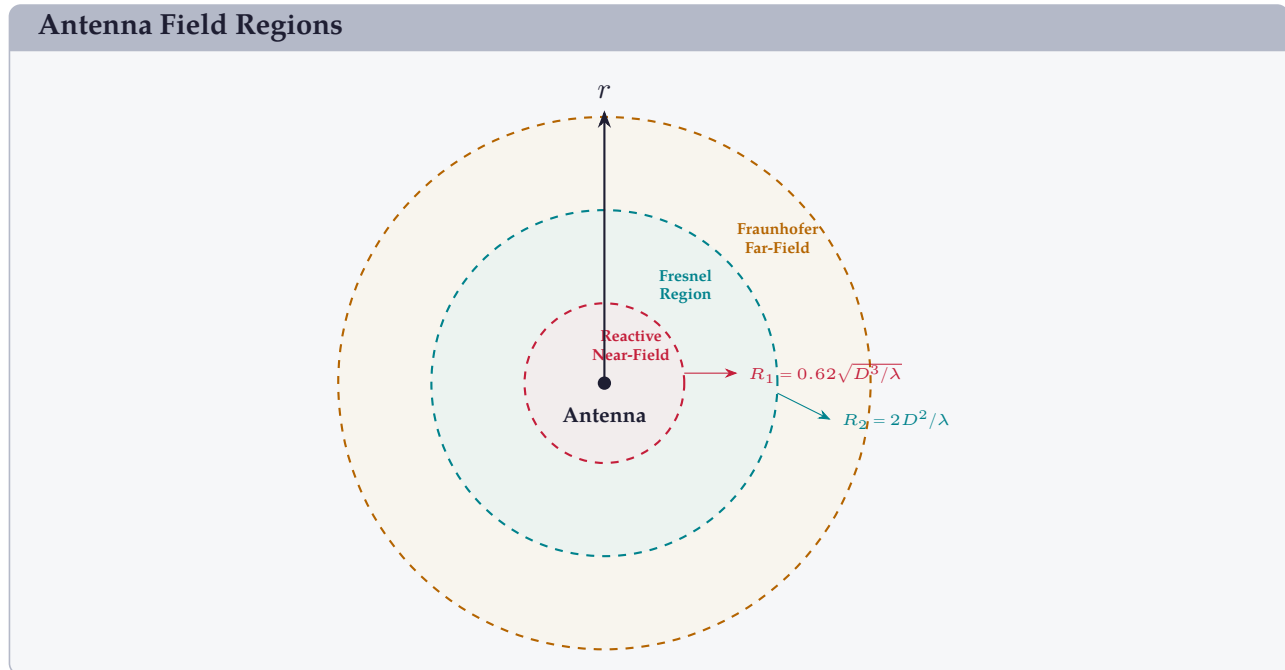


2.2 Half-Power Beamwidth (HPBW) and First-Null Beamwidth (FNBW)

- **Half-Power Beamwidth (HPBW):** The angular width of the main beam between two directions where the radiation intensity is half (3 dB below) the maximum value.
- **First-Null Beamwidth (FNBW):** The angular width between the first two nulls (where the radiation intensity drops to zero) on either side of the main beam.

2.3 Antenna Field Regions

The space surrounding an antenna is divided into three regions depending on the distance r from the antenna. Let D be the maximum dimension of the antenna, and λ be the wavelength.



1. **Reactive Near-Field Region:** The region immediately surrounding the antenna where the reactive fields (non-radiating, storing energy like a capacitor or inductor) are dominant. The boundary is:

$$r < R_1 = 0.62\sqrt{\frac{D^3}{\lambda}}$$

2. **Radiating Near-Field (Fresnel) Region:** The region between the reactive near-field and far-field where radiation fields dominate, but the angular field distribution depends on the distance from the antenna (because phase variations across the aperture are significant). The boundary is:

$$0.62\sqrt{\frac{D^3}{\lambda}} \leq r < R_2 = \frac{2D^2}{\lambda}$$

3. **Far-Field (Fraunhofer) Region:** The region where the angular distribution of the electromagnetic fields is independent of the distance. The wave behaves as a local transverse electromagnetic (TEM) plane wave, where the electric and magnetic fields are orthogonal to the direction of propagation. The boundary is:

$$r \geq \frac{2D^2}{\lambda} \quad (\text{provided } D \gg \lambda \text{ and } r \gg \lambda)$$

3. Reciprocity, Directivity, and Gain

3.1 Reciprocity Theorem

The reciprocity theorem states that the electrical characteristics (such as radiation pattern, directivity, input impedance, and effective length) of an antenna remain identical whether it is operated as a transmitter or a receiver.

Mathematical Formulation: Let two antennas A and B exist in a linear, isotropic, and homogenous medium. If a voltage source V_1 applied at the terminals of antenna A produces a current I_2 at the short-circuited terminals of antenna B , and a voltage source V_2 applied at the terminals of antenna B produces a current I_1 at the short-circuited terminals of antenna A , then:

$$\text{If } V_1 = V_2 \implies I_1 = I_2 \quad (\text{or } Z_{12} = Z_{21})$$

3.2 Directivity and Gain

- **Radiation Intensity (U):** The power radiated per unit solid angle (expressed in Watts/steradian).

$$U(\theta, \phi) = r^2 W_{rad}(\theta, \phi)$$

where W_{rad} is the radial component of the Poynting vector.

- **Directivity (D):** The ratio of the radiation intensity in a given direction to the average radiation intensity (which is equal to the intensity of an isotropic radiator).

$$D = \frac{U(\theta, \phi)}{U_0} = \frac{4\pi U(\theta, \phi)}{P_{rad}}$$

where $P_{rad} = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi U(\theta, \phi) \sin \theta d\theta d\phi$ is the total radiated power.

- **Gain (G):** The ratio of the radiation intensity in a given direction to the radiation intensity that would be obtained if the total power accepted by the antenna (P_{in}) was radiated isotropically.

$$G = \frac{4\pi U(\theta, \phi)}{P_{in}}$$

- **Relationship between Gain and Directivity:**

$$G = \eta_{cd} D$$

where η_{cd} is the antenna radiation efficiency ($0 \leq \eta_{cd} \leq 1$), representing conduction and dielectric losses.

4. Effective Aperture and Polarization

4.1 Effective Aperture (A_e)

The **effective aperture** (or effective area) of a receiving antenna is a measure of its ability to extract power from a passing electromagnetic wave. It is defined as the ratio of the delivered power P_L at the load terminals (matched condition) to the power density W_{inc} of the incident wave.

Effective Aperture and Directivity Relation

The delivered power is $P_L = A_e W_{inc}$. The relationship between the maximum effective aperture A_{em} and the maximum directivity D_0 for any antenna is:

$$A_{em} = \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi} D_0$$

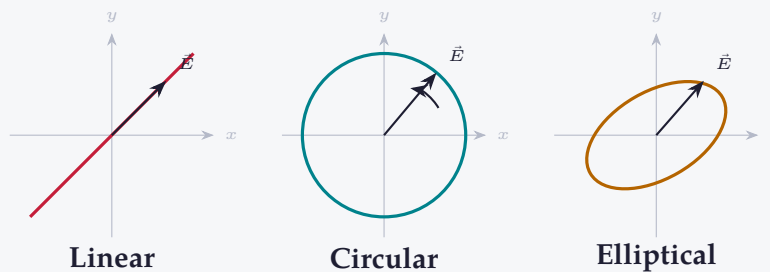
4.2 Polarization

The **polarization** of an antenna is defined as the polarization of the electromagnetic wave radiated by the antenna in a given direction. It describes the orientation of the electric field vector $\vec{E}$ as a function of time.

There are three main types of polarization:

- **Linear Polarization:** The electric field vector oscillates along a straight line. This occurs when the two orthogonal field components E_x and E_y are in-phase (phase difference $\Delta\psi = 0$ or 180°).
- **Circular Polarization:** The electric field vector traces out a circle. This requires $E_x = E_y$ and $\Delta\psi = \pm 90^\circ$ ($\pm\pi/2$ rad).
- **Elliptical Polarization:** The electric field vector traces an ellipse. This is the general case when $E_x \neq E_y$ and/or the phase difference is arbitrary (excluding linear/circular conditions).

Traces of Polarization States



5. Input Impedance, Efficiency, and Friis Transmission Equation

5.1 Input Impedance

The **input impedance** (Z_{in}) of an antenna is the impedance presented by the antenna at its terminals. It consists of a real part (input resistance R_{in}) and an imaginary part (input reactance X_{in}):

$$Z_{in} = R_{in} + jX_{in}$$

The input resistance R_{in} is composed of:

$$R_{in} = R_r + R_L$$

where R_r is the **radiation resistance** (representing the power converted into radiated waves) and R_L is the **loss resistance** (representing conduction and dielectric heating losses).

5.2 Antenna Efficiency

The total antenna efficiency (η_0) accounts for all losses in the system:

$$\eta_0 = \eta_r \eta_c \eta_d = \eta_r \eta_{cd}$$

where:

- $\eta_r = 1 - |\Gamma|^2$ is the reflection (mismatch) efficiency (Γ is the reflection coefficient).
- η_c is the conduction efficiency.
- η_d is the dielectric efficiency.
- $\eta_{cd} = \eta_c \eta_d = \frac{R_r}{R_r + R_L}$ is the radiation efficiency.

5.3 Friis Transmission Equation

The Friis transmission equation relates the power received by an antenna (P_r) to the power transmitted by another antenna (P_t), separated by a distance r in free space.

Friis Transmission Formula

Let G_t be the gain of the transmitting antenna and G_r be the gain of the receiving antenna. The received power is:

$$P_r = P_t G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi r} \right)^2 (PLF)$$

where $PLF = |\hat{\rho}_t \cdot \hat{\rho}_r|^2$ is the Polarization Loss Factor ($0 \leq PLF \leq 1$). For matched polarizations, $PLF = 1$.

Derivation:

1. The power density W_t radiated by an isotropic source at distance r is:

$$W_{isotropic} = \frac{P_t}{4\pi r^2}$$

2. For a directive transmitting antenna with gain G_t , the power density in its direction of maximum radiation is:

$$W_t = \frac{P_t G_t}{4\pi r^2}$$

3. The receiving antenna collects this energy using its effective aperture A_{er} :

$$P_r = W_t A_{er} = \left(\frac{P_t G_t}{4\pi r^2} \right) A_{er}$$

4. Using the relationship between effective aperture and gain ($A_{er} = G_r \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi}$):

$$P_r = \left(\frac{P_t G_t}{4\pi r^2} \right) \left(G_r \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi} \right) = P_t G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi r} \right)^2$$

6. Radiation Integrals and Potential Functions

To calculate the fields radiated by an antenna, we use auxiliary potential functions rather than solving Maxwell's equations directly. The most common vector potentials are:

- $\vec{A}$ (Magnetic Vector Potential): Created by electric current sources $\vec{J}$.
- $\vec{F}$ (Electric Vector Potential): Created by magnetic current sources $\vec{M}$ (equivalent currents).

6.1 Relationship between Potentials and Fields

For a magnetic vector potential $\vec{A}$, the magnetic flux density is:

$$\vec{B} = \nabla \times \vec{A} \implies \vec{H} = \frac{1}{\mu} \nabla \times \vec{A}$$

From Maxwell's equation $\nabla \times \vec{E} = -j\omega\mu\vec{H}$, we substitute $\vec{H}$ to get:

$$\vec{E} = -j\omega\vec{A} - \frac{j}{\omega\mu\epsilon} \nabla(\nabla \cdot \vec{A})$$

6.2 Inhomogeneous Helmholtz Wave Equation

From Maxwell's equations, the potential function $\vec{A}$ satisfies:

$$\nabla^2 \vec{A} + k^2 \vec{A} = -\mu \vec{J}$$

where $k = \omega\sqrt{\mu\epsilon} = 2\pi/\lambda$ is the wave number.

The solution to this inhomogeneous wave equation in free space is:

$$\vec{A}(x, y, z) = \frac{\mu}{4\pi} \iiint_V \vec{J}(x', y', z') \frac{e^{-jkR}}{R} dV'$$

where:

- (x', y', z') are the coordinates of the source currents.
- (x, y, z) are the coordinates of the observation point.
- $R = \sqrt{(x - x')^2 + (y - y')^2 + (z - z')^2}$ is the distance from the source point to the observation point.

In the far field, the distance R can be approximated as $R \approx r - r' \cos \psi$ for phase terms, and $R \approx r$ for amplitude terms. This simplifies the vector potential to:

$$\vec{A} \approx \frac{\mu e^{-jkr}}{4\pi r} \iiint_V \vec{J}(x', y', z') e^{jkr' \cos \psi} dV'$$

Quick Revision — Module 1

Fundamental Concepts of Antennas | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

Radiation Intensity (U)	$U = r^2 W_{rad}$ (Watts/steradian)
Directivity (D)	$D = \frac{4\pi U}{P_{rad}}$
Gain (G)	$G = \eta_{cd} D = \frac{4\pi U}{P_{in}}$
Effective Aperture-Gain Relation	$A_{em} = \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi} D_0$
Friis Transmission Equation	$P_r = P_t G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi r}\right)^2 (PLF)$
Helmholtz Equation Solution	$\vec{A} = \frac{\mu}{4\pi} \iiint \vec{J} \frac{e^{-jkR}}{R} dV'$
Helmholtz Wave Number (k)	$k = \frac{2\pi}{\lambda} = \omega \sqrt{\mu\epsilon}$

One-Line Definitions

- **Transducer:** A device that converts energy from one form to another; antennas convert guided electromagnetic waves into free-space waves.
- **Radiation Pattern:** The spatial distribution of physical quantities (like power or field intensity) radiated by an antenna.
- **HPBW:** The angle between the two directions in which the radiation intensity is half of the maximum.
- **Reactive Near-Field:** The region closest to the antenna where reactive non-radiating energy is stored.
- **Far-Field (Fraunhofer) Region:** The region where waves behave as transverse electromagnetic (TEM) plane waves and the pattern does not change with distance.
- **Reciprocity:** The property where transmitting and receiving characteristics of an antenna are identical.
- **Polarization Loss Factor (PLF):** A factor measuring mismatch loss between the polarization of a wave and the receiving antenna.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. What is the physical mechanism of antenna radiation?

Radiation is produced by accelerated or decelerated charges, or equivalently, by time-varying currents. Charges oscillating on a conductor generate changing electric and magnetic fields that propagate outward as electromagnetic waves.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q2. State the three field regions of an antenna and write their boundary equations.

- Reactive near-field: $r < 0.62\sqrt{D^3/\lambda}$
- Radiating near-field (Fresnel): $0.62\sqrt{D^3/\lambda} \leq r < 2D^2/\lambda$
- Far-field (Fraunhofer): $r \geq 2D^2/\lambda$

Q3. Define directivity. How is it different from power gain?

Directivity is the ratio of radiation intensity in a given direction to average radiation intensity (purely directional focus). Power gain also accounts for efficiency (conduction and dielectric losses) in addition to directional focus ($G = \eta_{cd}D$).

Q4. State the reciprocity theorem for antennas.

The transmitting and receiving properties of an antenna (pattern, impedance, directivity) are identical. A voltage source V at the terminals of antenna A produces current I at antenna B , and the same source V at B produces the same current I at A .

Q5. What is Polarization Loss Factor (PLF)? What is its value for a vertically polarized antenna receiving a horizontally polarized wave?

PLF measures the loss due to polarization mismatch between the incoming wave and the receiving antenna. For orthogonal polarizations (vertical vs. horizontal), $PLF = 0$ (zero power is received).

Q6. Derive the relationship between effective aperture and directivity.

Under thermodynamic equilibrium, the ratio of maximum effective aperture to directivity is constant for all antennas: $\frac{A_{em}}{D_0} = \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi}$. Thus, $A_{em} = \frac{\lambda^2}{4\pi} D_0$.

Q7. Explain the physical meaning of radiation resistance.

It is an equivalent resistance that would dissipate the same amount of power as heat as the antenna actually radiates into free space: $R_r = \frac{2P_{rad}}{I_0^2}$.

Q8. State the Friis transmission equation. What parameters does it relate?

$P_r = P_t G_t G_r \left(\frac{\lambda}{4\pi r}\right)^2$. It relates received power (P_r) to transmitted power (P_t) based on antenna gains (G_t, G_r), operating wavelength (λ), and separation distance (r).

Q9. What are auxiliary potential functions? Why are they used?

Auxiliary vector potentials ($\vec{A}$ and $\vec{F}$) are mathematical helper functions. They are used because it is much simpler to compute the potentials from the current distributions ($\vec{J}, \vec{M}$) and then take derivatives to get the fields ($\vec{E}, \vec{H}$), rather than solving Maxwell's equations directly.

Q10. Under what conditions does a charge radiate?

A charge radiates only if it is accelerated or decelerated. A stationary charge or a charge moving with constant velocity along a straight, infinite transmission line does not radiate.

Comparison of Field Regions

Property	Reactive Near-Field	Radiating Near-Field	Far-Field
Dominant Field Type	Reactive fields (energy storage)	Radiating fields (reactive fields decay)	Radiating fields (pure real power)
Pattern Shape	Changes drastically with distance	Varies with distance (r)	Independent of distance (r)
Phase Fronts	Highly complex	Non-spherical	Spherical (locally planar)
Wave Impedance	Complex (reactive)	Varies	Real ($\approx 377 \Omega$ in free space)

Module 2

Infinitesimal Dipole

1. Infinitesimal Dipole

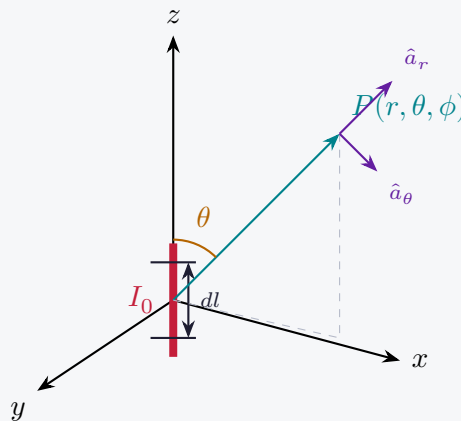
Definition of Infinitesimal Dipole

An **infinitesimal dipole** (also known as a Hertzian dipole) is a thin linear antenna whose length dl is extremely small compared to the wavelength ($dl \ll \lambda$) and whose current is assumed to be uniform ($I(z) = I_0 = \text{constant}$) over its entire length.

1.1 Coordinate System and Potential Derivation

Consider a wire of length dl placed symmetrically at the origin along the z -axis. Since the current is along z , the current density is $\vec{J} = \hat{a}_z I_0 \delta(x') \delta(y')$ for $-dl/2 \leq z' \leq dl/2$.

Infinitesimal Dipole Geometry



The magnetic vector potential $\vec{A}$ at a distance r (since $r \gg dl$) is:

$$\vec{A}(r) = \hat{a}_z \frac{\mu I_0 dl}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr}$$

Using coordinate transformations, the spherical components of $\vec{A}$ are:

$$\begin{aligned} A_r &= A_z \cos \theta = \frac{\mu I_0 dl \cos \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr} \\ A_\theta &= -A_z \sin \theta = -\frac{\mu I_0 dl \sin \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr} \\ A_\phi &= 0 \end{aligned}$$

1.2 Electromagnetic Field Equations

By applying Maxwell's relations ($\vec{H} = \frac{1}{\mu} \nabla \times \vec{A}$ and $\vec{E} = \frac{1}{j\omega\epsilon} \nabla \times \vec{H}$), we obtain the complete field equations:

$$\begin{aligned} H_\phi &= j \frac{k I_0 dl \sin \theta}{4\pi r} \left[1 + \frac{1}{jkr} \right] e^{-jkr} \\ E_r &= \frac{2 I_0 dl \eta \cos \theta}{4\pi r^2} \left[1 + \frac{1}{jkr} \right] e^{-jkr} \\ E_\theta &= j \frac{k I_0 dl \eta \sin \theta}{4\pi r} \left[1 + \frac{1}{jkr} - \frac{1}{(kr)^2} \right] e^{-jkr} \end{aligned}$$

where $\eta = \sqrt{\mu/\epsilon} \approx 120\pi \approx 377 \Omega$ is the intrinsic impedance of free space. Other components $H_r = H_\theta = E_\phi = 0$.

1.3 Far-Field Approximation and Radiation Resistance

For the far field ($kr \gg 1$), terms containing $1/(kr)^2$ and $1/(kr)^3$ can be neglected. The fields simplify to:

$$\begin{aligned} H_\phi &\approx j \frac{I_0 k dl \sin \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr} \\ E_\theta &\approx j \eta \frac{I_0 k dl \sin \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr} \end{aligned}$$

The total power radiated is found by integrating the Poynting vector over a closed sphere:

$$P_{rad} = \int_0^{2\pi} \int_0^\pi \frac{1}{2} \text{Re}(E_\theta H_\phi^*) r^2 \sin \theta d\theta d\phi = 40\pi^2 I_0^2 \left(\frac{dl}{\lambda} \right)^2$$

Since $P_{rad} = \frac{1}{2} I_0^2 R_r$, the radiation resistance R_r of an infinitesimal dipole is:

$$R_r = 80\pi^2 \left(\frac{dl}{\lambda} \right)^2$$

Note: The Short Dipole

For a **short dipole** (length $l \ll \lambda$, but current decreases linearly from I_0 at the center to 0 at the ends), the average current is $I_0/2$. The radiation resistance is 1/4 of the infinitesimal dipole:

$$R_r = 20\pi^2 \left(\frac{l}{\lambda} \right)^2$$

2. Finite-Length Dipole

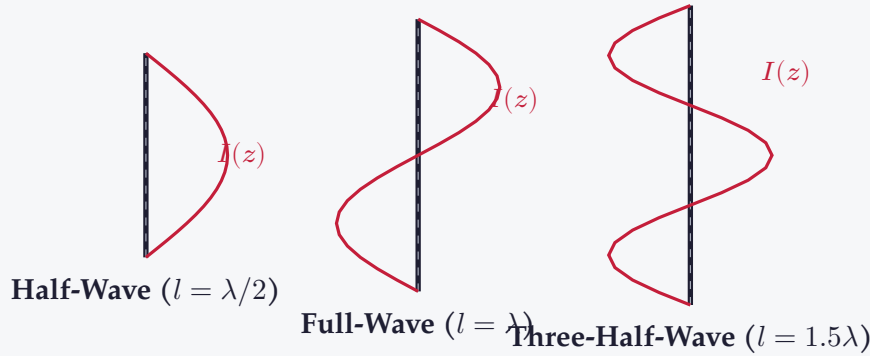
When the antenna length is comparable to the wavelength, the current is no longer uniform. It forms a standing wave with a sinusoidal distribution (assuming thin wire and zero current at the ends).

2.1 Current Distribution

For a dipole of length l placed along the z -axis, the current distribution is:

$$I(z') = I_0 \sin \left[k \left(\frac{l}{2} - |z'| \right) \right], \quad -l/2 \leq z' \leq l/2$$

Current Distributions on Dipoles



2.2 Far-Field Radiation Pattern

By treating the finite dipole as an infinite sum of infinitesimal dipoles and integrating the contributions, the far-field electric field is:

$$E_\theta \approx j\eta \frac{I_0 e^{-jkr}}{2\pi r} \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{kl}{2} \cos\theta\right) - \cos\left(\frac{kl}{2}\right)}{\sin\theta} \right]$$

$$H_\phi = \frac{E_\theta}{\eta}$$

2.3 The Half-Wave Dipole ($l = \lambda/2$)

Setting $l = \lambda/2$ (and thus $kl/2 = \pi/2$) in the field equations:

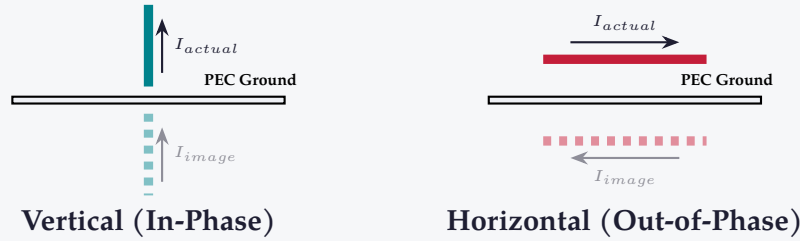
$$E_\theta \approx j\eta \frac{I_0 e^{-jkr}}{2\pi r} \left[\frac{\cos\left(\frac{\pi}{2} \cos\theta\right)}{\sin\theta} \right]$$

- **Radiation Resistance:** $R_r \approx 73 \Omega$.
- **Input Impedance:** $Z_{in} \approx 73 + j42.5 \Omega$ (inductive reactant due to end effects).
- **Resonant Length:** To make the input impedance purely real ($Z_{in} \approx 73 + j0 \Omega$), the dipole is shortened slightly by about 5% ($l \approx 0.47\lambda - 0.48\lambda$).
- **Directivity (D_0):** 1.64 (2.15 dBi).
- **HPBW:** 78° .

3. Linear Elements Near Conductors (Image Theory)

To analyze antennas placed near flat, perfectly conducting ground planes, we replace the ground plane with an equivalent virtual antenna below the plane. This is called **Image Theory**.

Image Theory Equivalents



3.1 Boundary Rules for Image Currents

- **Vertical Element:** A vertical current element at distance h above a ground plane has an image element of the same length and direction (in-phase) at distance h below the plane.
- **Horizontal Element:** A horizontal current element at distance h above a ground plane has an image element of the same length but opposite direction (out-of-phase) at distance h below the plane.

4. Dipoles for Mobile Communication (Monopoles)

For mobile handsets and base stations, it is often impractical to use a symmetric double-sided dipole. Instead, a **monopole antenna** (a single wire placed perpendicular to a conducting ground plane) is used.

4.1 The Quarter-Wave Monopole ($l = \lambda/4$)

Using image theory, a monopole of length $l = \lambda/4$ on a perfect ground plane is equivalent to a half-wave dipole ($l = \lambda/2$) in free space, but only for the upper half-space ($z \geq 0$).

- **Fields ($z \geq 0$):** Identical to half-wave dipole fields.
- **Fields ($z < 0$):** Zero (shielded by ground plane).
- **Radiated Power ($P_{rad,mono}$):** Since it radiates only into the upper hemisphere, the radiated power for the same input current is half that of a dipole:

$$P_{rad,monopole} = \frac{1}{2} P_{rad,dipole}$$

- **Radiation Resistance ($R_{r,mono}$):**

$$R_{r,monopole} = \frac{1}{2} R_{r,dipole} = \frac{73}{2} \approx 36.5 \Omega$$

- **Directivity (D_{mono}):** Since the power is focused into half the volume, the directivity is double that of a dipole:

$$D_{monopole} = 2 \times D_{dipole} = 2 \times 1.64 = 3.28 \quad (5.16 \text{ dBi})$$

5. Small Circular Loop Antenna

Definition of Small Circular Loop

A **small circular loop antenna** is a loop antenna of radius a whose circumference is much smaller than the wavelength ($2\pi a \ll \lambda$), resulting in a uniform current distribution $I(z) = I_0$ along the loop.

5.1 Far-Field Radiated Fields

By using the magnetic vector potential $\vec{A} = \hat{a}_\phi A_\phi$, the far fields for a loop with area $S = \pi a^2$ are:

$$E_\phi \approx \frac{\eta k^2 I_0 S \sin \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr}$$

$$H_\theta \approx -\frac{E_\phi}{\eta} \approx -\frac{k^2 I_0 S \sin \theta}{4\pi r} e^{-jkr}$$

5.2 Radiation Resistance

The power radiated by the loop is integrated, leading to the radiation resistance:

$$R_r = 31200 \left(\frac{S}{\lambda^2} \right)^2 = 31200 \left(\frac{\pi a^2}{\lambda^2} \right)^2 \approx 320\pi^4 \left(\frac{a}{\lambda} \right)^4$$

Important Note: Small Loop as a Magnetic Dipole

The radiation pattern of a small loop has a torus/donut shape ($f(\theta) = \sin \theta$), which is identical to the pattern of an infinitesimal electric dipole. Thus, a small loop behaves as a **magnetic dipole** perpendicular to the plane of the loop. However, its radiation resistance is much smaller than that of an electric dipole of similar size, making it a less efficient radiator (often used primarily for receiving, e.g., AM radio).

Quick Revision — Module 2

Wire and Loop Antennas | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

Infinitesimal Dipole R_r	$R_r = 80\pi^2 \left(\frac{dl}{\lambda}\right)^2$ ($dl \ll \lambda$, uniform current)
Short Dipole R_r	$R_r = 20\pi^2 \left(\frac{l}{\lambda}\right)^2$ ($l \ll \lambda$, linear current)
Half-Wave Dipole R_r & D_0	$R_r \approx 73 \Omega$, $D_0 \approx 1.64$ (2.15 dBi)
Quarter-Wave Monopole R_r & D_0	$R_r \approx 36.5 \Omega$, $D_0 \approx 3.28$ (5.16 dBi)
Small Loop R_r	$R_r \approx 31200 \left(\frac{S}{\lambda^2}\right)^2$ ($S = \pi a^2$)
Dipole Current Profile	$I(z) = I_0 \sin[k(l/2 - z)]$
Resonant Dipole Length	$l_{resonant} \approx 0.47\lambda - 0.48\lambda$ (removes $+j42.5 \Omega$ reactance)

One-Line Definitions

- **Hertzian Dipole:** A theoretical, infinitely thin dipole antenna of length much smaller than a wavelength, carrying uniform current.
- **Resonant Antenna:** An antenna whose input impedance is purely resistive ($X_{in} = 0$) at its operating frequency.
- **Image Theory:** A mathematical method replacing a conducting boundary with virtual mirror-image current sources.
- **Quarter-Wave Monopole:** A single vertical wire of length $\lambda/4$ placed above a conducting ground plane.
- **Magnetic Dipole:** The dual of an electric dipole; represented physically by a small circular loop antenna.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. What is the difference between an infinitesimal dipole and a short dipole?

An infinitesimal dipole has a constant, uniform current along its length ($dl \ll \lambda$). A short dipole has current that drops off linearly from the center to zero at the ends ($l \ll \lambda$). Because of this current profile, the radiation resistance of a short dipole is one-quarter of that of an infinitesimal dipole.

Q2. Why does a half-wave dipole require shortening for resonance?

A physical half-wave dipole ($l = 0.5\lambda$) has an input impedance of $Z_{in} \approx 73 + j42.5 \Omega$. To eliminate the inductive reactance and make it resonant ($X_{in} = 0$), the antenna is shortened slightly to about $0.47\lambda - 0.48\lambda$.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q3. Compare a half-wave dipole and a quarter-wave monopole antenna.

A quarter-wave monopole on a ground plane has half the radiation resistance (36.5Ω vs. 73Ω) and twice the directivity (3.28 vs. 1.64, or 5.16 dBi vs. 2.15 dBi) of a free-space half-wave dipole, because its radiation is restricted to the upper hemisphere.

Q4. Explain how the image of a horizontal dipole differs from a vertical dipole.

For a vertical dipole, the image current is in the same direction (in-phase). For a horizontal dipole, the image current is in the opposite direction (out-of-phase), which causes the radiated field to cancel at grazing angles (0° elevation).

Q5. Why are small loop antennas rarely used as transmitting antennas?

Small loop antennas have a very small radiation resistance (proportional to $(a/\lambda)^4$). This makes their radiation efficiency extremely low, as most input power is lost as heat in the conductor. They are, however, excellent for receiving applications (like AM radio) where noise levels are high and matching can be tuned.

Q6. Write the far-field expressions for a half-wave dipole.

$E_\theta = j120I_0 \frac{e^{-jkr}}{2r} \left[\frac{\cos(\frac{\pi}{2} \cos \theta)}{\sin \theta} \right]$ and $H_\phi = \frac{E_\theta}{\eta}$. Other field components are zero.

Q7. What is the input impedance of a practical half-wave dipole at resonance?

At resonance, the input reactance is tuned to zero, and the input impedance is purely resistive: $Z_{in} \approx 73 \Omega$.

Comparison of Wire and Loop Antennas

Parameter	Hertzian Dipole	Half-Wave Dipole	Small Loop
Length / Size	$dl \ll \lambda$	$l = \lambda/2$	Radius $a \ll \lambda/2\pi$
Current Profile	Uniform (I_0)	Sinusoidal ($I_0 \cos kz$)	Uniform (I_0)
Radiation Resistance	$80\pi^2(dl/\lambda)^2$	73Ω	$31200(\pi a^2/\lambda^2)^2$
Directivity	1.5 (1.76 dBi)	1.64 (2.15 dBi)	1.5 (1.76 dBi)
Field Type	Electric Dipole	Finite Electric Dipole	Magnetic Dipole

Module 3

Huygens' Principle and Field Equivalence

1. Huygens' Principle and Field Equivalence

Huygens' Principle

Huygens' Principle states that each point on a primary wavefront behaves as a source of secondary spherical wavelets. These wavelets propagate outward at the speed of the wave in the medium, and the new wavefront at any subsequent time is the envelope of these secondary wavelets.

1.1 Field Equivalence Principle

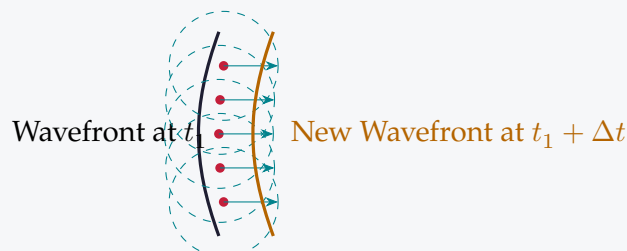
In electromagnetics, Schelkunoff's Equivalence Principle allows us to replace actual source currents inside a closed surface S with equivalent electric ($\vec{J}_s$) and magnetic ($\vec{M}_s$) currents on the surface S such that the fields outside S remain unchanged:

$$\vec{J}_s = \hat{n} \times \vec{H}$$

$$\vec{M}_s = -\hat{n} \times \vec{E}$$

where $\hat{n}$ is the unit outward normal vector to the surface S , and $\vec{E}$, $\vec{H}$ are the fields on S . This is critical for solving radiation patterns of aperture antennas.

Huygens' Wavelet propagation



2. Radiation from Apertures

Aperture antennas (like waveguides, horns, and reflectors) radiate through an opening in their structure. The radiated fields in the far field are proportional to the spatial Fourier transform of the field distribution across the aperture.

2.1 Rectangular Aperture (Uniform Distribution)

Consider a rectangular aperture of dimensions a (along x) and b (along y) in an infinite ground plane. If the aperture field is uniform and x -polarized, $\vec{E}_a = \hat{a}_x E_0$, the far-field pattern is:

$$E(\theta, \phi) \propto \text{sinc}\left(\frac{ka}{2} \sin \theta \cos \phi\right) \text{sinc}\left(\frac{kb}{2} \sin \theta \sin \phi\right)$$

where $\text{sinc}(x) = \frac{\sin x}{x}$.

- **Maximum Directivity:**

$$D_{max} = \frac{4\pi}{\lambda^2} A_p = \frac{4\pi}{\lambda^2} (ab)$$

- **Beamwidth (HPBW):**

$$\text{HPBW}_{E\text{-plane}} \approx 50.6^\circ \frac{\lambda}{b}, \quad \text{HPBW}_{H\text{-plane}} \approx 50.6^\circ \frac{\lambda}{a}$$

2.2 Circular Aperture (Uniform Distribution)

For a circular aperture of radius a with a uniform field, the far-field pattern is described by a Bessel function:

$$E(\theta) \propto \frac{J_1(ka \sin \theta)}{ka \sin \theta}$$

where J_1 is the first-order Bessel function.

- **Maximum Directivity:**

$$D_{max} = \frac{4\pi}{\lambda^2} A_p = \frac{4\pi}{\lambda^2} (\pi a^2) = \left(\frac{2\pi a}{\lambda}\right)^2$$

- **First Null Angle:** $\theta_{null} \approx 1.22 \frac{\lambda}{2a}$.
- **First Sidelobe Level:** 17.6 dB below the main beam peak.

3. Babinet's Principle and Slot Antennas

3.1 Babinet's Principle

In optics, Babinet's Principle states that the sum of the diffraction fields behind two complementary screens (where the transparent areas of one screen correspond to the opaque areas of the other) equals the field of the source when no screen is present.

3.2 Electromagnetic Extension (Booker's Relation)

H. G. Booker extended Babinet's principle to account for electromagnetic vector properties (polarization and boundary conditions). It relates the input impedance of a slot antenna (Z_{slot}) to the impedance of its complementary metal strip dipole (Z_{dipole}):

Booker's Impedance Relation

For complementary slot and dipole antennas in free space:

$$Z_{slot} Z_{dipole} = \frac{\eta_0^2}{4}$$

where $\eta_0 \approx 377 \Omega \approx 120\pi$ is the intrinsic impedance of free space.

Substituting $\eta_0 \approx 120\pi$:

$$Z_{slot} Z_{dipole} = \frac{(120\pi)^2}{4} \approx 35476 \Omega^2$$

Implications:

- Since a resonant thin dipole has $Z_{dipole} \approx 73 \Omega$, its complementary slot antenna has a resonant input impedance of:

$$Z_{slot} = \frac{35476}{73} \approx 485 \Omega$$

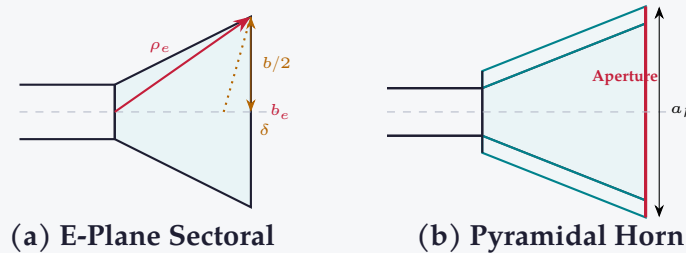
- The polarization of the slot antenna is orthogonal to that of the dipole. A vertical slot antenna radiates horizontally polarized waves, whereas a vertical dipole radiates vertically polarized waves.

4. Horn Antennas

A **horn antenna** is a flared waveguide that provides a smooth transition from waveguide impedance to free-space impedance, producing high directivity.

4.1 Types of Horns

- **E-Plane Sectoral Horn:** Flared only in the direction of the electric field (E -field).
- **H-Plane Sectoral Horn:** Flared only in the direction of the magnetic field (H -field).
- **Pyramidal Horn:** Flared in both E and H directions. It has a rectangular aperture.
- **Conical Horn:** Circular waveguide flared into a cone.

Horn Antenna Structures

4.2 Design Concepts and Path Length Difference

Flaring the waveguide causes a phase variation across the horn's aperture because waves traveling to the outer edge of the horn travel a longer path length (ρ) than waves traveling along the center axis. The maximum path difference δ is:

$$\delta = \rho \left(1 - \cos \frac{\theta}{2} \right) \approx \frac{b^2}{8\rho}$$

where b is the aperture height and ρ is the horn length. To prevent destructive interference, δ must be kept within limit:

- For E -plane horn: $\delta_{max} < \lambda/4 \implies b^2 < 2\lambda\rho_e$.
- For H -plane horn: $\delta_{max} < 3\lambda/8 \implies a^2 < 3\lambda\rho_h$.

5. Reflector Antennas

Reflector antennas use a metallic surface to redirect and focus electromagnetic waves from a primary source (feed) into a highly directive beam.

5.1 Prime-Focus Parabolic Reflector

A paraboloidal reflector is a surface of revolution formed by rotating a parabola about its axis. A primary feed (e.g., dipole or small horn) is placed at the focal point F .

Parabolic Reflector Configurations



Characteristics:

- Converts a spherical wavefront radiating from the feed into a highly directive plane wavefront.
- All path lengths from the feed to the reflector and out to the aperture plane are identical: $r + r \cos \theta = 2f$.
- The f/D ratio (focal length to diameter) is a critical design parameter that determines the curvature of the dish and feed antenna illumination requirements.

5.2 Cassegrain Antenna (Dual-Reflector)

A **Cassegrain antenna** uses a primary parabolic main reflector and a secondary hyperbolic sub-reflector.

- **Setup:** The primary feed horn is placed at a convenient location, usually at the vertex of the main reflector. The sub-reflector is positioned between the feed and the main focus.
- **Ray Path:** Spherical waves from the feed are reflected by the hyperbolic sub-reflector, directing them toward the main parabolic reflector as if they originated from the paraboloid's focus. The main reflector then reflects them as a collimated plane wave.

Cassegrain Advantages:

Feature	Cassegrain Advantage
Feed Line Loss	Feed is at the vertex; eliminates long, lossy feed lines to the focus.
Noise Temperature	Feed looks up at the cold sky (via sub-reflector) rather than down at the warm, noisy earth, reducing receiver noise.
Structural Support	Heavy feed equipment (amplifiers, cryogenics) is mounted behind the dish, rather than being suspended at the focus.

Quick Revision — Module 3

Aperture and Reflector Antennas | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

Aperture Max Directivity	$D_{max} = \frac{4\pi}{\lambda^2} A_p$ (uniform distribution)
Circular Apertity Null	$\theta_{null} \approx 1.22 \frac{\lambda}{2a}$
Booker's Relation	$Z_{slot} Z_{dipole} = \frac{\eta_0^2}{4} \approx 35476 \Omega^2$
Resonant Slot Impedance	$Z_{slot} \approx 485 \Omega$ (complementary to 73Ω dipole)
Horn Flare Limit (E-plane)	$b^2 < 2\lambda\rho_e$ (limits phase error to $< \pi/2$)
Horn Flare Limit (H-plane)	$a^2 < 3\lambda\rho_h$ (limits phase error to $< 3\pi/4$)
Parabola Equation	$y^2 = 4fx$ (f = focal length)

One-Line Definitions

- **Equivalence Principle:** A principle allowing actual source fields inside a closed boundary to be replaced by equivalent surface currents.
- **Aperture Efficiency:** The ratio of the effective aperture of an antenna to its physical aperture area.
- **Complementary Screens:** Two screens where the open areas of one correspond to the closed areas of the other.
- **Optimum Horn:** A horn antenna whose dimensions are chosen to achieve maximum gain for a fixed flare length.
- **Spillover Loss:** Power radiated by the feed antenna that misses the reflector dish and is lost.
- **Cassegrain Antenna:** A dual-reflector system using a parabolic main reflector and a hyperbolic sub-reflector.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. State Babinet's principle and its electromagnetic extension (Booker's relation).

Babinet's principle states that the sum of the fields behind complementary screens equals the source field without screens. Booker's relation extends this to EM fields, showing that for a slot antenna and its complementary dipole, $Z_{slot} Z_{dipole} = \frac{\eta_0^2}{4}$.

Q2. Why does a slot antenna have a high input impedance compared to a dipole?

By Booker's relation, $Z_{slot} Z_{dipole} \approx 35476$. Because a resonant dipole has $Z_{dipole} \approx 73 \Omega$, its complementary slot antenna has a high impedance: $Z_{slot} =$

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

$$\frac{35476}{73} \approx 485 \Omega.$$

Q3. Compare the polarization of a vertical slot antenna and a vertical dipole.

They are orthogonal. A vertical dipole radiates vertically polarized waves, whereas a vertical slot antenna radiates horizontally polarized waves (because the electric field lines span horizontally across the vertical slot).

Q4. Why are horn antennas flared? What happens if the flare angle is too large?

Flaring provides a gradual impedance match from the waveguide to free space, reducing reflections. If the flare angle is too large, the path difference between central and edge rays becomes large, causing phase errors that degrade gain and increase sidelobes.

Q5. What are the advantages of a Cassegrain reflector over a prime-focus parabolic reflector?

- Lower transmission line loss because the feed is located at the vertex.
- Lower noise temperature since the feed points upward at the cold sky.
- Easy installation and maintenance of heavy feed and receiver electronics.

Q6. Explain the trade-off involved in the f/D ratio of a parabolic reflector.

A small f/D (deep dish) reduces spillover but requires a wide-angle feed, which is hard to design with uniform phase. A large f/D (flat dish) simplifies feed design but increases spillover loss and requires a longer, heavier feed structure.

Q7. State the field equivalence principle and its use in aperture antennas.

It allows replacing the actual sources inside a closed surface with equivalent electric and magnetic currents on the surface. It simplifies analyzing slot, horn, or aperture antennas by integrating fields across the aperture rather than calculating currents on complex conductors.

Comparison of Aperture Antenna Types

Parameter	Slot Antenna	Horn Antenna	Parabolic Reflector
Directivity / Gain	Low to Medium	Medium (10–25 dB)	Very High (30–50 dB)
Bandwidth	Narrow (resonant)	Wide (waveguide band)	Extremely Wide
Impedance	High ($\approx 485 \Omega$)	Matched to waveguide	Matches feed antenna
Typical Applications	Aircraft, radar arrays	Feed for reflectors, gain standards	Satellite TV, radar, radio astronomy

Module 4

Yagi-Uda Antenna

1. Yagi-Uda Antenna

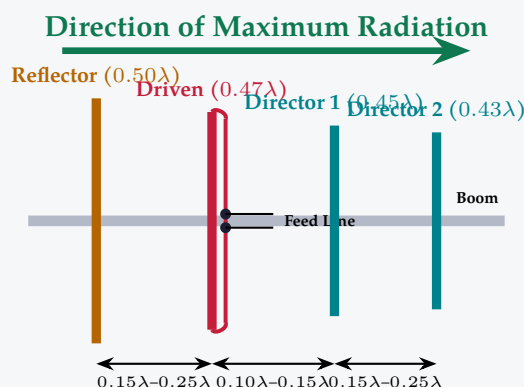
Definition of Yagi-Uda Antenna

The **Yagi-Uda antenna** is a highly directional, narrow-band antenna consisting of a single driven element (usually a half-wave folded dipole) and one or more parasitic elements (a reflector behind it, and directors in front of it) aligned along a central supporting boom.

1.1 Structure and Elements

The parasitic elements are not connected to the feed line. They receive energy through mutual electromagnetic coupling from the driven element and re-radiate it.

Yagi-Uda Antenna Layout



- 1. Driven Element:** Typically a folded dipole of resonant length 0.47λ – 0.48λ . The folded dipole structure increases the input impedance from $73\ \Omega$ to around $300\ \Omega$, facilitating impedance matching with standard twin-lead transmission lines.
- 2. Reflector:** Placed behind the driven element. It is approximately 5% longer than the driven element ($\approx 0.50\lambda$) and spaced 0.15λ – 0.25λ away. Because it is longer, it is inductive. It redirects the wave in the forward direction.
- 3. Directors:** Placed in front of the driven element in the direction of the main beam. They are 5% shorter than the driven element ($\approx 0.40\lambda$ – 0.45λ) and spaced 0.10λ – 0.30λ apart. Because they are shorter, they are capacitive, directing wave propagation forward.

1.2 Characteristics

- **Directivity/Gain:** Typically 7–15 dB depending on the number of director elements.
- **Bandwidth:** Narrow (typically 2% to 10%).
- **Front-to-Back Ratio:** High, meaning it effectively rejects noise from the back.

2. Log-Periodic Antennas

Definition of Log-Periodic Antenna

A **Log-Periodic Dipole Array (LPDA)** is a multi-element directional antenna designed to operate over an extremely wide bandwidth. Its electrical characteristics (gain, radiation pattern, input impedance) repeat periodically with the logarithm of the frequency.

2.1 Geometric Scaling Laws

The physical dimensions of the LPDA elements scale according to a geometric progression. Let L_n be the length of the n -th dipole element, d_n be the spacing between the n -th and $(n + 1)$ -th elements, and R_n be the distance from the apex to the n -th element.

LPDA Scaling Ratios

The geometric scale factor τ and spacing factor σ are defined as:

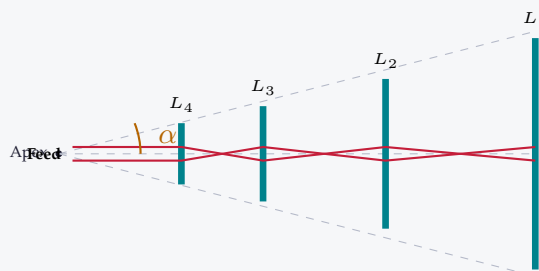
$$\tau = \frac{L_{n+1}}{L_n} = \frac{R_{n+1}}{R_n} = \frac{d_{n+1}}{d_n} \quad (0 < \tau < 1)$$

$$\sigma = \frac{d_n}{2L_n}$$

The apex angle 2α of the structure is related to these ratios by:

$$\tan \alpha = \frac{L_n - L_{n+1}}{2R_n} = \frac{1 - \tau}{4\sigma}$$

Log-Periodic Dipole Array (LPDA)



2.2 Principle of Operation (Active Region)

The feed line is cross-phased between adjacent elements (a 180° phase twist). This configuration ensures that at any given frequency:

- **Transmission Region:** Elements that are too short ($L \ll \lambda/2$) present a high capacitive reactance and do not draw much current; they act as a transmission line.
- **Active Region:** Elements whose length is close to half a wavelength ($L \approx \lambda/2$) are resonant. They draw the majority of the current and radiate.
- **Reflective Region:** Elements that are too long ($L \gg \lambda/2$) are highly inductive and act as reflectors.

As the operating frequency increases, the active region shifts toward the smaller elements at the apex, maintaining constant beamwidth and input impedance.

3. Frequency Independent Antennas

3.1 Rumsey's Principle

Rumsey's Principle states that an antenna will be frequency-independent if its physical shape is defined entirely by angles, with no characteristic scale length. If the dimensions are scaled, the antenna looks identical except for a rotation.

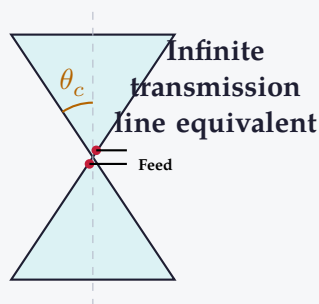
3.2 Examples

- **Biconical Antenna:** Formed by two co-axial metallic cones with their vertices facing each other. It behaves as a broadband version of a dipole.
- **Equiangular Spiral Antenna:** The boundary curves are defined in polar coordinates by:

$$r = r_0 e^{a\phi}$$

Because the shape is defined purely by exponential growth and angles, it has infinite theoretical bandwidth (practically limited by feed-point dimensions at high frequencies and outer boundaries at low frequencies).

Biconical Antenna Geometry



4. Broadcast Antennas

Broadcast applications require omnidirectional radiation patterns in the horizontal plane to cover a 360° service area.

4.1 Turnstile Antenna

A **turnstile antenna** consists of two identical horizontal half-wave dipoles placed perpendicular to each other (90° spatial separation) and excited with a 90° phase difference.

- The E-field components in the horizontal plane are:

$$E_1 = E_0 \cos \phi, \quad E_2 = E_0 \sin \phi e^{j\pi/2} = jE_0 \sin \phi$$

- The total field is:

$$E_{total} = E_1 + E_2 = E_0(\cos \phi + j \sin \phi) = E_0 e^{j\phi}$$

- The magnitude $|E_{total}| = E_0$ is constant, producing a perfectly circular (omnidirectional) radiation pattern in the horizontal plane with circular polarization.

4.2 Vertical Mast Radiators

For Medium Frequency (MF) AM radio broadcasting, vertical steel towers (mast radiators) of height $H \approx \lambda/4$ or $H \approx 0.583\lambda$ (the anti-fading height, which minimizes sky-wave interference near the ground) are used. The ground acts as a reflector, forming a monopole equivalent.

Quick Revision — Module 4

Broadband and Broadcast Antennas | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

LPDA Scale Factor (τ)	$\tau = \frac{L_{n+1}}{L_n} = \frac{R_{n+1}}{R_n} = \frac{d_{n+1}}{d_n} < 1$
LPDA Spacing Factor (σ)	$\sigma = \frac{d_n}{2L_n}$
LPDA Apex Angle (α)	$\tan \alpha = \frac{1-\tau}{4\sigma}$
Log-Spiral Geometry	$r = r_0 e^{a\phi}$ (defined purely by angles)
Yagi Driven Element Length	$L \approx 0.47\lambda - 0.48\lambda$ (usually folded dipole)
Yagi Reflector Length	$L \approx 0.50\lambda$ (inductive, reflects wave forward)
Yagi Director Length	$L \approx 0.40\lambda - 0.45\lambda$ (capacitive, steers wave forward)

One-Line Definitions

- **Parasitic Element:** An antenna element not electrically connected to the receiver/transmitter, excited via mutual coupling.
- **Folded Dipole:** A dipole antenna with its ends folded back and joined, providing a four-fold increase in input impedance.
- **Active Region:** The zone in a log-periodic array where elements are near resonance ($\approx \lambda/2$) and actively radiating.
- **Rumsey's Principle:** The condition that an antenna shape defined only by angles is frequency-independent.
- **Turnstile Antenna:** An arrangement of two crossed dipoles fed out of phase to produce a circular, omnidirectional horizontal pattern.
- **Anti-Fading Mast:** A vertical tower radiator of height $\approx 0.583\lambda$ that suppresses high-angle sky-wave radiation.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. Explain the operation of parasitic elements in a Yagi-Uda antenna.

The reflector (longer than $\lambda/2$) acts inductively, shifting the phase of its re-radiated field to add constructively with the driven element's field in the forward direction. The directors (shorter than $\lambda/2$) act capacitively, shifting the phase to pull the beam forward.

Q2. Why is a folded dipole used as the driven element in a Yagi-Uda antenna?

Adding parasitic elements near a dipole severely lowers its input impedance (often down to $< 15\Omega$), causing mismatch loss. A folded dipole has a high

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

impedance ($300\ \Omega$ in free space), which drops to a convenient $50\text{--}75\ \Omega$ in the array, making it easy to match to coaxial cables.

Q3. What is the difference between a broadband antenna and a frequency-independent antenna?

A broadband antenna operates over a wide range (e.g., Yagi-Uda with 10% bandwidth). A frequency-independent antenna satisfies Rumsey's principle (angular geometry) and has a practically unlimited bandwidth (often 10 : 1 or more), as its active zone shifts continuously with frequency.

Q4. How does a Log-Periodic Dipole Array (LPDA) achieve frequency independence?

As frequency changes, the "active region" (elements near $\lambda/2$ resonance) moves smoothly along the boom. The active elements scale geometrically, so the antenna's electrical size relative to the operating wavelength remains constant.

Q5. What parameters define the geometry of an LPDA?

The geometric scale factor τ (ratio of adjacent lengths/spacings), the spacing factor σ (ratio of spacing to element length), and the apex angle α .

Q6. How does a Turnstile antenna produce an omnidirectional pattern in the horizontal plane?

It uses two crossed horizontal dipoles fed in phase quadrature (90° phase shift). The resulting fields $E_0 \cos \phi$ and $jE_0 \sin \phi$ combine vectorially to yield a constant amplitude $|E| = E_0$ at all horizontal angles ϕ .

Q7. Why is the height of 0.583λ chosen for AM broadcast mast radiators?

At 0.583λ , the antenna produces maximum ground-wave radiation while minimizing high-angle sky-wave radiation. This reduces interference between the ground wave and the ionospheric sky wave, preventing fading in the primary coverage zone.

Yagi-Uda vs. Log-Periodic Dipole Array (LPDA)

Parameter	Yagi-Uda Antenna	Log-Periodic (LPDA)
Bandwidth	Narrow (typically 2%–10%)	Extremely Wide (10 : 1 ratio or more)
Gain	High (7–15 dB depending on elements)	Moderate (6–10 dB)
Element Design	Parasitic elements of specific lengths	Driven elements of geometrically scaled lengths
Feeder Connection	Driven element only (others mutually coupled)	All elements connected to a cross-phased line

Module 5

Characteristics of Microstrip Antennas

1. Characteristics of Microstrip Antennas

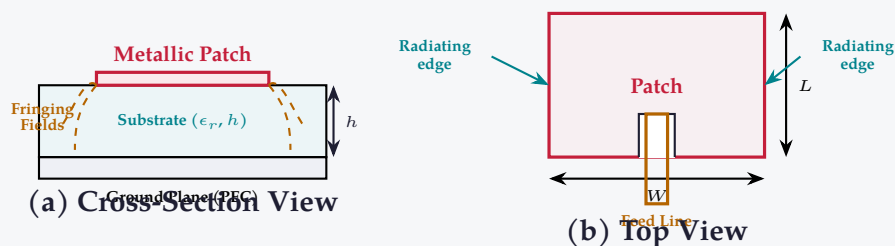
Definition of Microstrip Patch Antenna

A **microstrip patch antenna** consists of a radiating metallic patch (usually rectangular or circular) etched on one side of a thin, grounded dielectric substrate (dielectric constant ϵ_r and thickness h , where $h \ll \lambda$).

1.1 Physical Structure and Radiation Mechanism

The metallic patch is usually made of copper or gold. The substrate thickness is typically $0.003\lambda_0 \leq h \leq 0.05\lambda_0$. The patch acts as a resonant cavity with open-circuited edges. Fringing fields at the edges of the patch (along the length) act as the source of radiation. These fields extend slightly outside the physical boundaries, meaning the patch behaves electrically as if it were slightly larger than its physical dimensions.

Rectangular Microstrip Patch Antenna (Cross-Section and Top View)



Advantages and Disadvantages:

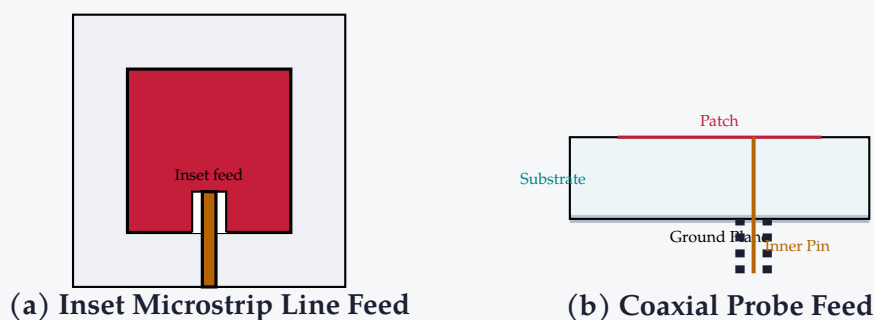
Advantages	Disadvantages
Low profile, lightweight, conformable to surfaces.	Extremely narrow bandwidth (typically 1%–5%).
Low fabrication cost (easy to print on PCBs).	Low radiation efficiency (due to dielectric and surface losses).
Supports dual-frequency and dual-polarization.	Low power handling capability.

2. Feeding Methods

To transfer electromagnetic energy into the patch, several feed techniques are used:

- 1. Microstrip Line Feed:** A microstrip conducting strip feed is directly connected to the edge of the patch.
 - *Match method:* Inset cuts are made in the patch to match the high patch edge impedance to the feed line.
 - *Pros/Cons:* Easy to fabricate; but causes spurious feed radiation.
- 2. Coaxial Probe Feed:** The outer conductor of a coaxial cable is connected to the ground plane, and the inner pin extends through the substrate and is soldered to the patch.
 - *Match method:* Match is achieved by choosing the insertion point offset from the patch edges.
 - *Pros/Cons:* Low spurious radiation; but requires drilling holes, making it harder to fabricate.
- 3. Aperture-Coupled Feed:** The feed line is on a lower substrate, separated from the patch substrate by a common ground plane. Coupling occurs via a slot/aperture cut in the ground plane.
 - *Pros/Cons:* Shields feed line spurious radiation, improves bandwidth; but requires multilayer fabrication.
- 4. Proximity-Coupled Feed:** The feed line is sandwiched between two substrate layers, and the patch is on the top surface. Energy couples electromagnetically.
 - *Pros/Cons:* Widest bandwidth (up to 13%), no contact needed; but complex to align.

Microstrip Line Feed vs. Coaxial Probe Feed



3. Methods of Analysis

- **Transmission Line Model:** Simplest model. It represents the patch as a microstrip transmission line of length L terminated by two radiating slots (modeled as parallel conductances G and susceptances B). It yields good physical insight but is less accurate.

- **Cavity Model:** Represents the region between the patch and ground plane as a dielectric-loaded cavity with electric conductors on top/bottom, and artificial magnetic walls along the patch edges. It is more accurate and models higher-order modes.
- **Full-Wave Models:** Numerical techniques (such as the Method of Moments (MoM), Finite Element Method (FEM), or Finite Difference Time Domain (FDTD)). They are highly accurate for arbitrary shapes but are computationally demanding.

4. Design of Rectangular and Circular Patch Antennas

4.1 Rectangular Patch Antenna Design

The design parameters are: substrate height h , dielectric constant ϵ_r , and resonant frequency f_r .

Rectangular Patch Design Calculations

1. **Width (W):** To ensure high radiation efficiency, the width is:

$$W = \frac{v_0}{2f_r} \sqrt{\frac{2}{\epsilon_r + 1}}$$

where $v_0 \approx 3 \times 10^8$ m/s.

2. **Effective Dielectric Constant (ϵ_{eff}):** Accounts for fringing fields:

$$\epsilon_{eff} = \frac{\epsilon_r + 1}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_r - 1}{2} \left[1 + 12 \frac{h}{W} \right]^{-1/2}$$

3. **Extended Patch Length (ΔL):** Due to fringing fields:

$$\Delta L = 0.412h \frac{(\epsilon_{eff} + 0.3) \left(\frac{W}{h} + 0.264 \right)}{(\epsilon_{eff} - 0.258) \left(\frac{W}{h} + 0.8 \right)}$$

4. **Physical Length (L):**

$$L = L_{eff} - 2\Delta L = \frac{v_0}{2f_r \sqrt{\epsilon_{eff}}} - 2\Delta L$$

4.2 Circular Patch Antenna Design

For a circular patch of radius a on a substrate of height h , the dominant resonant mode is TM_{110}^z .

Circular Patch Design Equations

The physical radius a is calculated as:

$$a = \frac{F}{\left\{1 + \frac{2h}{\pi\epsilon_r F} \left[\ln \left(\frac{\pi F}{2h} \right) + 1.7726 \right] \right\}^{1/2}}$$

where:

$$F = \frac{8.791 \times 10^9}{f_r \sqrt{\epsilon_r}} \quad (\text{for } f_r \text{ in Hz})$$

The effective radius a_e incorporating fringing fields is:

$$a_e = a \left\{ 1 + \frac{2h}{\pi\epsilon_r a} \left[\ln \left(\frac{\pi a}{2h} \right) + 1.7726 \right] \right\}^{1/2}$$

The resonant frequency for the TM_{110}^z mode is:

$$(f_r)_{110} = \frac{1.8412v_0}{2\pi a_e \sqrt{\epsilon_r}}$$

Quick Revision — Module 5

Microstrip Antennas | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

Rectangular Patch Width
(W)

$$W = \frac{v_0}{2f_r} \sqrt{\frac{2}{\epsilon_r + 1}}$$

Effective Dielectric (ϵ_{reff})

$$\epsilon_{reff} = \frac{\epsilon_r + 1}{2} + \frac{\epsilon_r - 1}{2} \left[1 + 12 \frac{h}{W} \right]^{-1/2}$$

Extended Length (ΔL)

$$\Delta L \approx 0.412h \frac{(\epsilon_{reff} + 0.3)(W/h + 0.264)}{(\epsilon_{reff} - 0.258)(W/h + 0.8)}$$

Physical Length (L)

$$L = \frac{v_0}{2f_r \sqrt{\epsilon_{reff}}} - 2\Delta L$$

Resonant circular frequency

$$(f_r)_{110} = \frac{1.8412v_0}{2\pi a_e \sqrt{\epsilon_r}}$$

Effective circular radius (a_e)

$$a_e = a \left\{ 1 + \frac{2h}{\pi \epsilon_r a} \left[\ln \left(\frac{\pi a}{2h} \right) + 1.7726 \right] \right\}^{1/2}$$

One-Line Definitions

- **Fringing Fields:** The bending of electric field lines at the open-circuit boundaries of a microstrip patch, which enables radiation.
- **Inset Feed:** A feed technique where notch cuts are made in the patch to match the low line impedance ($\approx 50 \Omega$) directly inside the patch.
- **Transmission Line Model:** An analytical model that treats a rectangular patch antenna as two radiating slots separated by a transmission line.
- **Cavity Model:** An analysis model that treats the patch as a cavity bounded by perfect electric and magnetic walls.
- **Full-Wave Analysis:** Direct numerical solvers of Maxwell's equations (e.g., FEM, FDTD) used for complex microstrip geometries.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. What is the primary mechanism of radiation in microstrip patch antennas?

Radiation is generated by the fringing fields at the patch edges. These fringing fields act as slot sources along the radiating edges (separated by $L \approx \lambda/2$).

Q2. Compare microstrip line feeding and coaxial probe feeding.

Microstrip line feeds are simple to fabricate but introduce spurious radiation from the feed line, which degrades the radiation pattern. Coaxial probe feeding offers lower spurious radiation and easy matching, but requires drilling holes, making fabrication more complex.

Q3. What is the purpose of an inset feed in microstrip antennas?

The input impedance at the edge of a patch is high (typically $200\text{--}300 \Omega$). An

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

inset notch shifts the contact point of the feed line toward the center of the patch, where the impedance is lower, matching it to a standard $50\ \Omega$ transmission line.

Q4. Why does a microstrip patch antenna have a narrow bandwidth?

The patch antenna behaves electrically as a high-Q resonant cavity with a small volume. Since the substrate height h is thin ($h \ll \lambda$), the energy stored in the cavity is high compared to the energy radiated, leading to a narrow bandwidth.

Q5. Explain the physical meaning of the effective dielectric constant (ϵ_{eff}).

Because the fringing field lines travel partly through the dielectric substrate and partly through the surrounding air, the wave behaves as if it were propagating through a homogeneous medium with a dielectric constant ϵ_{eff} that lies between 1 (air) and ϵ_r (substrate).

Q6. State the advantages of aperture-coupled feeds over direct feeding methods.

The ground plane separates the feed line from the radiating patch, preventing spurious feed line radiation from distorting the antenna's far-field radiation pattern. It also allows independent optimization of the feed and patch substrate thicknesses.

Comparison of Patch Feeding Methods

Feed Type	Ease of Fab	Spurious Radiation	Relative Bandwidth
Microstrip Line	Very Easy	High	Narrow (1–2%)
Coaxial Probe	Moderate (requires drilling)	Low	Narrow (1–3%)
Aperture Coupled	Complex (multilayer alignment)	Lowest (shielded by ground)	Moderate (4–5%)
Proximity Coupled	Complex (multilayer alignment)	Low	Widest (10–13%)

Module 6

Uniform Linear Arrays (ULA)

1. Uniform Linear Arrays (ULA)

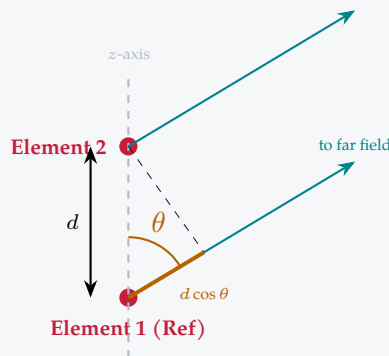
Definition of an Antenna Array

An **antenna array** is a set of two or more identical antenna elements positioned and excited such that their individual radiation fields combine constructively in desired directions and cancel destructively in other directions, increasing directivity.

1.1 Two-Element Array Analysis

Consider two identical antennas separated by a distance d along the z -axis. Antenna 1 is at the origin and serves as the phase reference ($I_1 = I_0 e^{j0}$). Antenna 2 is fed with a phase lead β ($I_2 = I_0 e^{j\beta}$).

Two-Element Array Geometry



In the far field, the path difference between the waves is $d \cos \theta$ (where θ is measured from the array axis). The total phase difference ψ between the fields is:

$$\psi = kd \cos \theta + \beta$$

The total far-field electric field is:

$$E_{total} = E_1 + E_2 = E_0 (1 + e^{j(kd \cos \theta + \beta)}) = E_0 e^{j\psi/2} \left(2 \cos \frac{\psi}{2} \right)$$

The normalized **Array Factor (AF)** is:

$$AF_n(\theta) = \cos \left(\frac{kd \cos \theta + \beta}{2} \right)$$

1.2 N-Element Uniform Linear Array (ULA)

For N identical elements fed with equal amplitude I_0 and progressive phase shift β :

$$AF = \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} e^{jn(kd \cos \theta + \beta)} = \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} e^{jn\psi}$$

Summing this geometric progression:

$$|AF| = \left| \frac{\sin\left(\frac{N}{2}\psi\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{1}{2}\psi\right)} \right| \Rightarrow |AF_n| = \left| \frac{\sin\left(\frac{N}{2}(kd \cos \theta + \beta)\right)}{N \sin\left(\frac{1}{2}(kd \cos \theta + \beta)\right)} \right|$$

1.3 Broadside vs. End-Fire Arrays

1. Broadside Array: Maximum radiation is perpendicular to the array axis ($\theta = 90^\circ$).

- *Condition:* $\psi = 0$ at $\theta = 90^\circ \Rightarrow kd \cos(90^\circ) + \beta = 0 \Rightarrow \beta = 0$.
- *Nulls:* Occur when $\sin(N\psi/2) = 0 \Rightarrow \theta_{null} = \cos^{-1}\left(\pm \frac{m\lambda}{Nd}\right)$, $m = 1, 2, 3, \dots$

2. End-Fire Array: Maximum radiation is along the array axis ($\theta = 0^\circ$ or 180°).

- *Condition for $\theta = 0^\circ$:* $\psi = 0 \Rightarrow kd \cos(0^\circ) + \beta = 0 \Rightarrow \beta = -kd$.
- *Condition for $\theta = 180^\circ$:* $\psi = 0 \Rightarrow kd \cos(180^\circ) + \beta = 0 \Rightarrow \beta = kd$.

2. Non-Uniform Amplitude Arrays

Uniform arrays have high directivity but suffer from relatively high sidelobes (-13.5 dB for the first sidelobe). To reduce sidelobes, elements can be excited with non-uniform current amplitudes.

2.1 Binomial Array

The excitation amplitudes of the elements correspond to the coefficients of a binomial expansion:

$$a_n = \binom{N-1}{n}, \quad n = 0, 1, \dots, N-1$$

For example, for a 5-element array, the amplitudes scale as $1 : 4 : 6 : 4 : 1$.

- **Advantage:** Completely eliminates sidelobes if the element spacing $d \leq \lambda/2$.
- **Disadvantage:** Broader beamwidth (HPBW) and lower directivity than a uniform array of equivalent length.

2.2 Dolph-Tschebyscheff Array

This array uses Tschebyscheff (Chebyshev) polynomials $T_m(z)$ to design a pattern with a specified sidelobe level (SLL) and the narrowest possible main beamwidth. The Chebyshev polynomials are defined by:

$$T_m(z) = \cos(m \cos^{-1} z) \quad (|z| \leq 1)$$

$$T_m(z) = \cosh(m \cosh^{-1} z) \quad (|z| > 1)$$

This method optimizes the trade-off by ensuring that all sidelobes are at the exact same specified level (e.g., -20 dB or -30 dB).

3. Extension to Planar Arrays

A **planar array** consists of elements positioned in a two-dimensional grid (e.g., M elements along x with spacing d_x , and N elements along y with spacing d_y).

The overall Array Factor is the product of the individual linear array factors along the two directions:

$$AF_{planar} = AF_x \cdot AF_y = \left[\frac{\sin\left(\frac{M}{2}\psi_x\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{1}{2}\psi_x\right)} \right] \left[\frac{\sin\left(\frac{N}{2}\psi_y\right)}{\sin\left(\frac{1}{2}\psi_y\right)} \right]$$

where:

$$\psi_x = kd_x \sin \theta \cos \phi + \beta_x$$

$$\psi_y = kd_y \sin \theta \sin \phi + \beta_y$$

By dynamically adjusting the phase shifters β_x and β_y , the main beam can be steered to any coordinate (θ_0, ϕ_0) in 3D space:

$$\beta_x = -kd_x \sin \theta_0 \cos \phi_0$$

$$\beta_y = -kd_y \sin \theta_0 \sin \phi_0$$

4. Antenna Array Synthesis

Array synthesis involves finding the feeding currents (amplitudes and phases) and element locations required to produce a desired radiation pattern.

4.1 Schelkunoff Polynomial Method

Schelkunoff represented the array factor of an N -element linear array as a polynomial in the complex variable $z = e^{j\psi}$:

$$AF = \sum_{n=0}^{N-1} a_n z^n = a_{N-1}(z - z_1)(z - z_2) \dots (z - z_{N-1})$$

where z_i are the roots (zeros) of the polynomial. Since z lies on the unit circle ($|z| = 1$), the nulls in the radiation pattern correspond to the roots that lie on the unit circle. This allows designers to synthesize specific radiation pattern shapes by selecting root locations on the complex plane.

4.2 Woodward-Lawson Method

The Woodward-Lawson method synthesizes a desired source pattern by superimposing several independent, orthogonal beams (beams centered at different angles, each having a $\frac{\sin(N\psi/2)}{N \sin(\psi/2)}$ shape). The excitation coefficients of the array are found by sampling the desired pattern at the center coordinates of these orthogonal beams.

Quick Revision — Module 6

Antenna Arrays and Synthesis | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

N-Element ULA Array Factor (AF)	$AF = \frac{\sin(N\psi/2)}{\sin(\psi/2)}$ where $\psi = kd \cos \theta + \beta$
Broadside Phase Shift (β)	$\beta = 0$
End-Fire Phase Shift (β)	$\beta = \mp kd$ (for $\theta = 0^\circ$ or 180° main beam)
Binomial Array Coefficients	$a_n = \binom{N-1}{n} = \frac{(N-1)!}{n!(N-1-n)!}$
Planar Beam Steering Phase	$\beta_x = -kd_x \sin \theta_0 \cos \phi_0, \quad \beta_y = -kd_y \sin \theta_0 \sin \phi_0$
Schelkunoff Complex Variable (z)	$z = e^{j\psi} = e^{j(kd \cos \theta + \beta)}$

One-Line Definitions

- **Array Factor:** The radiation pattern of an array of isotropic elements, describing how the geometry and feeds affect the pattern.
- **Grating Lobe:** An unwanted duplicate main beam of radiation that occurs when element spacing $d \geq \lambda$.
- **Binomial Array:** An array with non-uniform excitation coefficients that completely eliminates sidelobes.
- **Phased Array:** An array where the phase of each element is dynamically adjusted to steer the radiation beam without moving the antenna.
- **Woodward-Lawson Method:** A pattern synthesis technique based on the superposition of orthogonal beam patterns.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. Define Array Factor (AF). State the Principle of Pattern Multiplication.

The Array Factor is the radiation pattern of the array assuming isotropic radiating elements. The Principle of Pattern Multiplication states that the total far-field pattern (E_{total}) of an array of identical non-isotropic elements is the product of the single-element field pattern (E_{single}) and the Array Factor (AF):

$$E_{total}(\theta, \phi) = E_{single}(\theta, \phi) \times AF(\theta, \phi)$$

Q2. Differentiate between broadside and end-fire arrays.

A broadside array radiates its maximum power perpendicular to the axis of the array ($\theta = 90^\circ$), which requires in-phase feeds ($\beta = 0$). An end-fire array radiates along the axis ($\theta = 0^\circ$ or 180°), which requires a progressive phase shift $\beta = \mp kd$.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q3. What are grating lobes? How can they be avoided in array design?

Grating lobes are secondary maximum beams that have the same amplitude as the main beam. They represent a waste of energy in undesired directions. They can be avoided by keeping the element spacing smaller than a wavelength ($d < \lambda$, or $d < \lambda/2$ for steering).

Q4. Why are binomial arrays designed? What is their main drawback?

Binomial arrays are designed to completely eliminate sidelobes in their radiation pattern. Their main drawback is that they produce a wider main beam width (reduced resolution) and have lower directivity compared to a uniform array of the same length.

Q5. Explain the key concept of the Dolph-Tschebyscheff array design.

It uses Chebyshev polynomials to find the optimal balance between beamwidth and sidelobe level. It yields the narrowest possible main beam width for a specified, constant sidelobe level.

Q6. Describe the basic idea of the Schelkunoff polynomial method.

The array factor is written as a complex polynomial $AF(z) = \sum a_n z^n$. The nulls of the radiation pattern correspond to the roots of the polynomial that lie on the unit circle in the complex plane ($|z| = 1$). Moving these roots allows shaping the pattern.

Q7. How does a 2D planar array steer a beam in three dimensions?

By using two independent progressive phase shifts β_x and β_y along the x - and y -axes, the phase can be matched to create a flat constructive wavefront in any direction (θ_0, ϕ_0) .

Comparison of Linear Array Types

Parameter	Uniform ULA	Binomial Array	Dolph-Tschebyscheff
Excitation Amplitudes	Equal (1 : 1 : 1 : 1)	Binomial coefficients (1 : 3 : 3 : 1)	Calculated using Chebyshev polynomials
Sidelobe Level	High (first SLL ≈ -13.5 dB)	No sidelobes (SLL = $-\infty$)	Constant SLL (set by designer)
Directivity	High	Low (broad beamwidth)	Optimum (narrowest beam for SLL)

Module 7

Basic Concepts of Smart Antennas

1. Basic Concepts of Smart Antennas

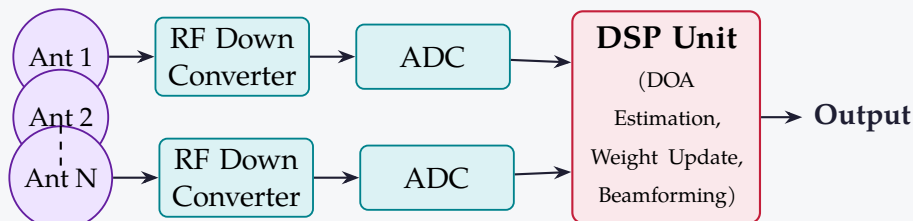
Definition of Smart Antennas

A **smart antenna** (or adaptive array) system combines an antenna array with digital signal processing (DSP) algorithms to automatically optimize its radiation pattern in response to the signal environment, steering beams toward desired users and placing nulls toward interferers.

1.1 Smart Antenna Architecture

A typical smart antenna receiver consists of an antenna array, an RF downconverter, analog-to-digital converters (ADCs), and a digital signal processor (DSP).

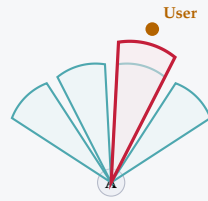
Smart Antenna Receiver Block Diagram



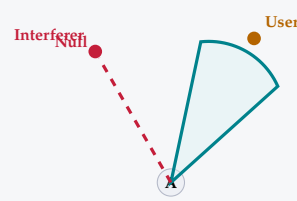
1.2 Beamforming Basics

- **Phased Array / Fixed-Weight Beamforming:** The weights (amplitudes and phases) are predefined or adjusted using analog phase shifters to steer the main beam in a specific fixed direction.
- **Adaptive Beamforming:** The weights are dynamically computed in real-time by a DSP processor using feedback algorithms to optimize the Signal-to-Interference-plus-Noise Ratio (SINR).
- **Algorithms:** Common adaptive weight-updating algorithms include:
 - **LMS (Least Mean Squares):** Low complexity, gradient descent.
 - **RLS (Recursive Least Squares):** Fast convergence, high complexity.
 - **MUSIC / ESPRIT:** High-resolution algorithms used to find the Direction of Arrival (DOA) of incoming signals.

Switched-Beam vs. Adaptive Array Patterns



(a) Switched-Beam

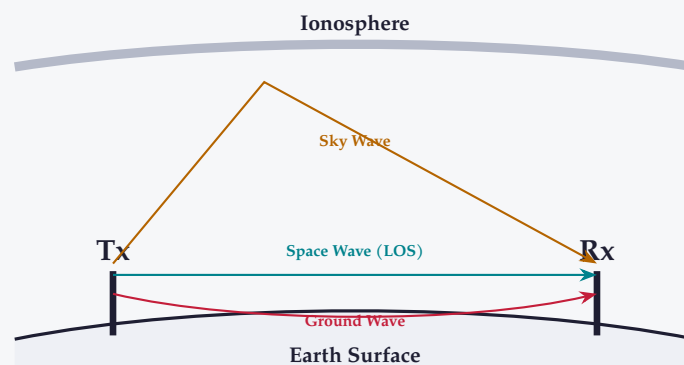


(b) Adaptive Array

2. Radio Wave Propagation Modes

Radio waves propagate from transmitter to receiver via three primary modes depending on their frequency.

Radio Wave Propagation Modes



2.1 Ground Wave (Surface Wave) Propagation

Ground waves travel along the surface of the Earth, guided by the boundary between the atmosphere and the ground.

- **Frequency Range:** Very Low Frequency (VLF) to Medium Frequency (MF) (< 2 MHz).
- **Mechanism:** The wave induces currents in the ground, causing attenuation. Attenuation increases rapidly with frequency, limiting this mode to low frequencies.
- **Application:** AM radio broadcasting, maritime communications.

2.2 Space Wave (Line-of-Sight) Propagation

Space waves travel through the troposphere directly from transmitter to receiver, or via ground reflection.

- **Frequency Range:** Very High Frequency (VHF) and above (> 30 MHz).

- **Radio Horizon (d):** The maximum line-of-sight distance is limited by the curvature of the Earth. Accounting for atmospheric refraction (effective Earth radius factor $k = 4/3$):

$$d \approx \sqrt{17h_t} + \sqrt{17h_r} \approx 4.12 (\sqrt{h_t} + \sqrt{h_r}) \text{ km}$$

where h_t and h_r are the heights of the transmitting and receiving towers in meters.

- **Other modes:** Tropospheric scatter, duct propagation.

2.3 Sky Wave Propagation

Sky waves travel upward and are reflected (refracted) back to Earth by the ionosphere.

- **Frequency Range:** High Frequency (HF) (3–30 MHz).
- **Ionospheric Layers:** Formed by solar UV/X-ray ionization.

Ionosphere Layers Properties:

Layer	Altitude	Day Behavior	Night Behavior
D Layer	50–90 km	Absorbs HF; reflects VLF/LF.	Disappears (recombines).
E Layer	90–140 km	Partially reflects HF.	Weakens significantly.
F1 Layer	140–250 km	Merges with F2 at night.	Disappears.
F2 Layer	250–400 km	Highest electron density; primary sky wave reflector.	Merges into a single F layer.

3. Ionospheric Parameters

The ionosphere acts as a refracting medium. Its refractive index n is:

$$n = \sqrt{1 - \frac{81N}{f^2}}$$

where N is the electron density (electrons/m³) and f is the wave frequency (Hz).

Key Sky-Wave Design Parameters

1. **Critical Frequency (f_c):** The highest frequency that is reflected back to Earth when launched vertically (90° elevation):

$$f_c = 9\sqrt{N_{max}}$$

2. **Maximum Usable Frequency (MUF):** The highest frequency reflected back to Earth when launched at an oblique angle of incidence θ_i :

$$f_{MUF} = f_c \sec \theta_i = \frac{f_c}{\cos \theta_i} \quad (\text{Secant Law})$$

3. **Skip Distance (D_{skip}):** The minimum distance from the transmitter where a sky

wave of frequency f ($f > f_c$) returns to Earth:

$$D_{skip} = 2h_{virt} \sqrt{\left(\frac{f_{MUF}}{f_c}\right)^2 - 1}$$

Quick Revision — Module 7

Smart Antennas and Propagation | PE-EC801A

Key Formulas and Metrics at a Glance

Radio Horizon Distance (d) $d \approx 4.12(\sqrt{h_t} + \sqrt{h_r})$ (in km, h in meters)

Ionospheric Refractive Index (n) $n = \sqrt{1 - \frac{81N}{f^2}}$

Critical Frequency (f_c) $f_c = 9\sqrt{N_{max}}$ (vertical incidence)

Oblique Secant Law (MUF) $f_{MUF} = f_c \sec \theta_i$

Skip Distance (D_{skip}) $D_{skip} = 2h\sqrt{(f_{MUF}/f_c)^2 - 1}$

Smart Weight Vector ($\vec{w}$) $\vec{y}(t) = \vec{w}^H \vec{x}(t)$ (combining array outputs)

One-Line Definitions

- **DOA Estimation:** Direction of Arrival; calculating the angle from which a signal hits the antenna array.
- **Adaptive Beamforming:** Real-time DSP weight adjustment to maximize wanted signals and null out noise/interference.
- **Ground Wave:** A low-frequency electromagnetic wave that travels guided by the curvature and conductivity of the Earth.
- **Skip Distance:** The minimum distance from a transmitter where sky wave signals return to the Earth's surface.
- **Critical Frequency:** The limit frequency below which waves return to Earth at vertical incidence, and above which they escape to space.
- **Duct Propagation:** The trapping of VHF/UHF waves in a tropospheric layer due to temperature inversions, allowing long-range propagation.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions

Q1. What are the benefits of using smart antennas in wireless networks?

Smart antennas increase system capacity (via Space Division Multiple Access - SDMA), extend coverage range (via directive beam gain), reduce co-channel interference (by steering nulls toward interferers), and mitigate multipath fading.

Q2. Compare switched-beam and adaptive array smart antennas.

Switched-beam systems select from a set of predefined, fixed beams. Adaptive arrays continuously track the user's location and steer the beam and nulls dynamically using DSP algorithms, offering higher performance but at a higher cost.

Frequently Asked / Viva Questions (contd.)

Q3. Explain the physical mechanism of ground wave propagation. Why is it limited to low frequencies?

As ground waves travel, they induce currents in the Earth's surface. Since the Earth acts as a lossy dielectric, it dissipates power. Ground attenuation increases rapidly with frequency, limiting this mode to frequencies below 2 MHz.

Q4. Define critical frequency, MUF, and skip zone.

- **Critical Frequency (f_c):** The maximum frequency reflected at vertical incidence.
- **MUF:** The maximum frequency reflected at oblique incidence ($f_{MUF} = f_c \sec \theta_i$).
- **Skip Zone:** The region between the limit of ground-wave coverage and the point where the first sky-wave returns to Earth. No signal is received in this zone.

Q5. Why does the D-layer of the ionosphere disappear at night?

The D-layer is the lowest layer (50–90 km) where atmospheric density is high. It is ionized during the day by solar radiation. At night, without solar rays, free electrons recombine rapidly with ions due to the high collision rate, causing the layer to disappear.

Q6. State the formula for the line-of-sight range of space waves. How does the earth's atmosphere affect it?

$d \approx 4.12(\sqrt{h_t} + \sqrt{h_r})$ km. The atmosphere has a refractive index that decreases with height, which bends waves slightly downward, extending the radio horizon about 15% beyond the geometric optical horizon. This is modeled using an effective Earth radius factor $k = 4/3$.

Comparison of Wave Propagation Modes

Parameter	Ground Wave	Space Wave	Sky Wave
Frequency Range	< 2 MHz (LF/MF)	> 30 MHz (VHF/UHF/SHF)	3–30 MHz (HF)
Propagation Path	Curves along Earth's surface	Direct line-of-sight path	Ionospheric reflection/refraction
Primary Limitation	High ground attenuation at higher frequencies	Earth curvature blockage (radio horizon)	Solar ionization variations (day/night/seasonal)
Typical Applications	AM radio, maritime navigation	FM, TV, cellular, satellite	Long-range amateur radio, SW broadcasting